

PRODUCT FIT · BUYER TARGETING

China Seafood Buyer Targeting Strategy

Where to win first — ranked buyers, product fit, and a sequenced sales plan across East, South & North China.

Yellowtail

Lobster

Abalone

China just dropped seafood duty to zero for South Africa

BEFORE

~16–20%

total import tax



NOW

0%

import duty · VAT only

Zero-tariff preference scheme for South Africa, **1 May 2026 → 30 April 2028** — a 2-year window under the China–Africa Economic Partnership Agreement (CAEPA), covering most goods including seafood.



What you pay to land in China now

Product	HS code	Before duty	Now duty	VAT	Total before	Total now	Savings
Yellowtail (fresh / frozen)	0302 / 0303	7–11%	0%	9%	~16–20%	~9%	7–11% ↓
Lobster (live / frozen)	0306	~7%	0%	9%	~16–18%	~9%	7–9% ↓
Abalone (fresh / live)	030781	7–10%	0%	9%	~17–20%	~9%	8–11% ↓
Abalone (processed)	160557	5%	0%	13%	~18–20%	~13%	5–7% ↓
Lobster (processed)	160530	5%	0%	13%	~18–19%	~13%	5–6% ↓

Note Import duty removed entirely — only VAT applies (9% fresh / frozen, 13% processed). HS classification determines the rate.

Now among the lowest-cost suppliers into China

~7–11% cheaper landed, instantly

Pure margin or pricing advantage vs EU, US and Japan — who still pay full duty plus VAT.

Level with the FTA suppliers

Now price-competitive with ASEAN (Vietnam, Indonesia) and Australia / New Zealand, who already held FTAs.

YELLOWTAIL

Scale volume now

Lower cost makes processing contracts with Kingsun, Zhoushan & Rizhao easier to win.

LOBSTER

Margin per kg jumps

High-value shipments to Shenzhen & Dalian gain the most — very competitive vs Canada & US.

ABALONE

Negotiating edge

China is the largest, most price-sensitive market — removing ~10% duty is decisive at scale.

CAPTURING THE 0% RATE

Zero duty isn't automatic — qualify first

Miss the paperwork and the importer pays full duty upfront, then reclaims it later.

1

Certificate of Origin

Issued by SARS — proves South African origin. The critical document.

2

Rules of Origin

Fish caught in SA waters, or substantially processed in South Africa.

3

Correct documentation

Accurate HS classification and complete paperwork at clearance.

4

Watch for quotas

A few product lines may carry volume limits — rare, but verify.

SAY THIS TO BUYERS

“Now zero import duty from South Africa — only VAT applies. We can offer a better landed price than other origins.”

Window: two years to April 2028 — lock in long-term buyers before competitors react.

PRODUCT FIT RANKINGS

Who buys what — ranked 1 = best fit

Company	City	Region	Yellowtail	Lobster	Abalone	Priority focus
Shandong Kingsun Foods	Qingdao	East	1	2	3	All-round buyer
Zhoushan Boda	Zhoushan	East	1	4	4	Yellowtail specialist
Dalian Rich Seafood	Dalian	North	3	1	2	Premium seafood
Shenzhen Traders (Honghua / Chuangxiao)	Shenzhen	South	3	1	1	Live high-value seafood
Rizhao Processors	Rizhao	East	2	4	4	Volume processing

Read: 1 = strongest product fit · 4 = weakest. Lower is better.

PRODUCT 1 · YELLOWTAIL

Yellowtail — your strongest opportunity

Widest, most consistent demand across the buyer set

BEST TARGETS

Shandong Kingsun consistent importer + processor

Zhoushan Boda directly handles yellowtail species

Rizhao Processors volume cutting / repack

Focus region East China — Qingdao + Zhoushan + Rizhao

Pitch Whole fish, frozen · processing yield · price per kg





PRODUCT 2 · LOBSTER

Lobster — the high-margin play

Fewer buyers, but premium value and strong margins

BEST TARGETS

Shenzhen Traders main entry for live lobster

Dalian Rich Seafood premium distribution

Shandong Kingsun secondary importer

Focus region South China (Shenzhen) + North (Dalian)

Pitch Live / frozen lobster supply · supply consistency

PRODUCT 3 · ABALONE

Abalone — the premium niche

Smaller market, highest quality and origin sensitivity

BEST TARGETS

Shenzhen Traders strongest live market

Dalian Rich Seafood premium retail / food service

Shandong Kingsun some trading capability

Focus region South China first

Pitch Premium positioning · origin story · quality grade



A simple, sequenced plan

01

Start here

HIGHEST-PROBABILITY WINS

- Kingsun (Qingdao)
- Zhoushan Boda
- Shenzhen Traders



02

Expand volume

SCALE THE PIPELINE

- Rizhao Processors
- Dalian Rich Seafood



03

Segment by product

MATCH PRODUCT TO REGION

- Yellowtail → East China
- Lobster → Shenzhen
- Abalone → Shenzhen + Dalian

Geography decides the pitch

EAST CHINA

Processing + volume

The yellowtail engine — Qingdao, Zhoushan & Rizhao for whole-fish supply and repack.

Yellowtail

SOUTH CHINA

Live + premium

Shenzhen is the entry point for live, high-value lobster and abalone.

Lobster · Abalone

NORTH CHINA

Distribution + upscale

Dalian anchors premium distribution into retail and food service.

Premium lobster · abalone

Bottom line Lead with yellowtail in the East to win volume fast, then convert Shenzhen and Dalian into premium lobster and abalone accounts.